

YOGENDRA PRATAP

SAFETY FIRST



SAFETY FEATURES OF CARS ARE ON THE MINDS OF BUYERS LIKE NEVER BEFORE. FROM SEAT BELTS TO CRASH TESTS, HERE'S WHAT YOU SHOULD LOOK OUT FOR





I get hundreds of queries every month across India about all types of cars that people want to buy—from those who ask about budget entry level cars to those who don't consider the price at all. Over the years, I have seen various trends emerge. Whether it is a shift towards a certain body style or the desirability of certain features, I know what people are interested in and what they finally buy. Over the past six months or so, there has been a big increase in queries about, firstly, electric cars and, secondly, how safe the cars in question are. While safety features have been on customers' minds for many years now, there used to be a big disconnect between the actual purchase decision and concerns about safety. This is beginning to change. The final purchase decision for more people is increasingly being influenced by safety features and ratings. But many are still confused about what constitutes a safe car and how to decide which is a safer car. Here are some pointers you can check that will help you choose a safer car.

First and foremost, no matter how safe a car is, if you aren't wearing a seat belt, you are placing your life in the hands of chance rather than being protected by safety features. This holds for every seat in the car, not just those in the front. In fact, rear seat passengers can cause injuries (that can be fatal) to people in the front if they are not wearing seat belts even if the latter are.

Various agencies crash test cars and rate them, including Global NCAP, which is testing Indian-made cars under its #SaferCarsForIndia campaign. Under these